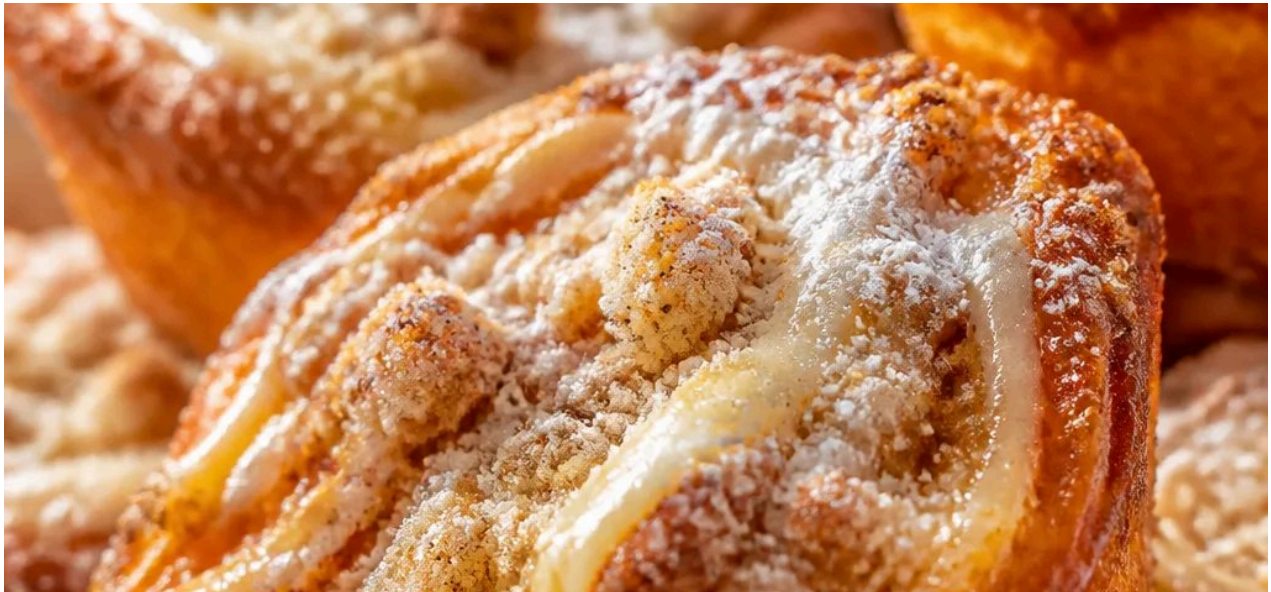




Pumpkin Cream Cheese Muffins Starbucks Copycat Recipe for Perfect Fall Mornings

These pumpkin cream cheese muffins are my go-to cozy fall treat. The soft, spiced pumpkin crumb pairs perfectly with a luscious cream cheese center that melts in your mouth. Great for weekend breakfasts or afternoon coffee breaks!



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15 min
PREP



30 min
COOK



45 min
TOTAL



12
SERVINGS



Easy
DIFFICULTY

Ingredients

- ☐ 1 3/4 cups all-purpose flour
- ☐ 1 teaspoon baking powder
- ☐ 1/2 teaspoon baking soda
- ☐ 1/2 teaspoon salt
- ☐ 1 teaspoon ground cinnamon

- ☐ 1/2 teaspoon ground nutmeg
- ☐ 1/4 teaspoon ground cloves
- ☐ 1/4 teaspoon ground ginger
- ☐ 1 cup canned pumpkin puree
- ☐ 1/2 cup granulated sugar
- ☐ 1/2 cup brown sugar, packed
- ☐ 1/2 cup vegetable oil
- ☐ 2 large eggs
- ☐ 1 teaspoon vanilla extract
- ☐ 8 ounces cream cheese, softened
- ☐ 1/4 cup granulated sugar (for cream cheese filling)
- ☐ 1 large egg yolk (for cream cheese filling)
- ☐ 1 teaspoon vanilla extract (for cream cheese filling)

Instructions

- 1** Preheat your oven to 350°F (175°C) and line a 12-cup muffin tin with paper liners. This ensures the muffins bake evenly and release easily. Mixing the dry ingredients first helps distribute the leavening agents and spices uniformly so each muffin has consistent flavor and rise. In a large bowl, whisk together the flour, baking powder, baking soda, salt, cinnamon, nutmeg, cloves, and ginger until fully combined. ⌚ 10
- 2** In a separate bowl, whisk the pumpkin puree with granulated sugar, brown sugar, vegetable oil, eggs, and vanilla extract until smooth and creamy. The sugars dissolve into the pumpkin, creating moisture and sweetness. Be careful not to overmix once you add the flour to avoid dense muffins. ⌚ 5
- 3** Gently fold the dry ingredients into the wet pumpkin mixture using a spatula until just combined. Overmixing activates gluten which can make muffins tough, so stop mixing as soon as you see no flour pockets. The batter should be thick and slightly lumpy. ⌚ 3
- 4** Prepare the cream cheese filling by beating together the softened cream cheese, granulated sugar, egg yolk, and vanilla extract until smooth and creamy. This mixture should be silky and easy to dollop, which helps it stay distinct inside the muffin during baking. ⌚ 5
- 5** Spoon about one tablespoon of pumpkin batter into each muffin cup, then add a heaping teaspoon of cream cheese filling in the center. Top with more pumpkin batter until the cup is about 3/4 full. This layering creates the signature gooey cream cheese core. ⌚ 7

- 6** Use a toothpick or knife to gently swirl the cream cheese into the pumpkin batter for a marbled effect without fully blending it. This ensures each bite has that creamy surprise without losing the pumpkin muffin texture.  3
- 7** Bake the muffins for 25-30 minutes until the tops are set and a toothpick inserted into the muffin (avoiding the cream cheese center) comes out clean. The muffins will puff up and edges turn golden brown, signaling they're perfectly baked.  30
- 8** Remove the muffins from the oven and let them cool in the tin for 5 minutes before transferring to a wire rack. Cooling slightly helps them firm up and prevents the cream cheese from leaking out when you bite in.  10
- 9** Serve warm or at room temperature with a light dusting of cinnamon sugar on top for extra flavor and a cozy finish. These muffins keep well and are perfect for make-ahead breakfasts or snacks throughout the week.  0

Chef Tips

 **Make sure your cream cheese is fully softened before mixing.**

Softened cream cheese blends smoothly with sugar and egg yolk to create a creamy filling that holds its shape during baking. If it's too cold, lumps can form and the filling won't swirl nicely, affecting the texture and appearance.

 **Don't overmix the batter once you add the dry ingredients.**

Overmixing activates gluten in the flour, which can lead to tough, dense muffins instead of tender, moist ones. Folding gently until just combined keeps the crumb light and soft.

 **Use paper liners in your muffin tin.**

Paper liners prevent sticking and help the muffins bake evenly. They also make cleanup easier and keep the edges tender rather than hardening against the pan.

Storage & Reheating

 **Refrigerator**

Store muffins in an airtight container in the refrigerator for up to 5 days. The cream cheese filling stays fresh longer when chilled. Reheat gently in the microwave for 15-20 seconds to soften before serving.

❄ Freezer

Freeze muffins individually wrapped in plastic wrap and stored in a freezer-safe bag for up to 3 months. Thaw overnight in the fridge or warm in the microwave for 30 seconds for a fresh-baked taste.

🔥 Reheating

Reheat muffins in a microwave on medium power for 15-30 seconds or in a 325°F oven for 5-7 minutes until warmed through. Adding a small dab of butter or wrapping in foil helps retain moisture.

Nutrition (per serving)

270 kcal CALORIES	5g PROTEIN	32g CARBS
13g FAT	2g FIBER	240mg SODIUM

Nutritional values are estimates and may vary based on specific ingredients used.

Thank You

Thank you for choosing this recipe collection. We hope it brings warmth and flavor to your kitchen.



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